

INTEGRATIVE COURSE PROGRESS REPORT

COURSE: IT CAPSTONE PROJECT 2	COURSE CODE: IT200-2D	SECTION: CIS444	SY/TERM: 2026-2027/3T
TITLE OF RESEARCH PROJECT: A WEB-BASED GOVERNMENT CONTRACTS INFORMATION SYSTEM WITH AUTHENTICITY VERIFICATION USING STEGANOGRAPHY-BASED ENCRYPTION TECHNIQUE			GROUP CODE: 2025IT007

INTEGRATIVE COURSES	THESIS PHASE
☐ THESIS ☒ CAPSTONE PROJECT ☐ FEASIBILITY STUDY	☐ PROPOSAL DEFENSE ☒ DATA GATHERING
☐ PLANT DESIGN ☐ BUSINESS PLAN	☐ FINAL DEFENSE

Name of Students (SURNAME, GIVEN NAME MI.)	Student No.	Program of Study	Signature
De Leon, Griffin D.	2022154126	BSIT	

DESCRIPTION OF WORK DONE FOR THE TIME PERIOD (Use back page or additional sheets if necessary)	
WEEK #: 1	COVERED DATE: April 4 - 10, 2026

FOCUS: Establish the initial SealGuard web and security prototype.

- Built the first HTML, JavaScript, and CSS interface and organized the Git repository.
- Scaffolded the Django project with contract models, upload and list views, authentication pages, and migrations.
- Added SHA-256 canonical fingerprinting, AES-256-CBC encryption, an LSB seal prototype, verification, and deletion flows.

TECHNICAL OUTCOME: A working local prototype could enroll, secure, list, and verify PDF contracts.

ISSUE AND RESPONSE: Rapid file uploads created an uneven structure, so the next sprint focused on consolidation.

MANUSCRIPT ALIGNMENT: Planning, design, and the Encryption and Verification and Document Management modules.

NEXT STEP: Consolidate the project and strengthen key handling.

To be filled up by adviser.		
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WEEK #: 2	COVERED DATE: April 11 - 18, 2026

FOCUS: Consolidate the Django prototype and strengthen cryptographic key protection.

- Moved the functional application into the repository root so settings, routes, models, and templates shared one structure.
- Added HMAC-SHA256 integrity data and RSA-wrapped AES keys through new contract fields and migrations.
- Retained upload, encryption, verification, and authentication behavior while updating setup documentation.

TECHNICAL OUTCOME: The prototype used layered hashing, symmetric encryption, integrity checking, and key wrapping.

ISSUE AND RESPONSE: Duplicate project trees risked divergence; one primary application layout was established.

MANUSCRIPT ALIGNMENT: Three-layer encryption design, hybrid cryptography, and secure Django implementation.

NEXT STEP: Extend verification to printed or scanned copies.

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WEEK #: 3	COVERED DATE: May 18 - 23, 2026

FOCUS: Develop the first physical-document verification workflow.

- Added a physical verification page and expanded PDF processing for seals, QR data, and embedded metadata.
- Stored the original fingerprint separately so the system could distinguish source content from the sealed output.
- Refined public verification logic and documented how to stop and restart the local development server.

TECHNICAL OUTCOME: The system gained an early bridge between digital records and printed-document checking.

ISSUE AND RESPONSE: Seal stamping changes PDF bytes; separate original and sealed fingerprints clarified comparison logic.

MANUSCRIPT ALIGNMENT: Scanning interface, steganographic extraction, AES decryption, and result display.

NEXT STEP: Integrate the security workflow with the final interface.

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WEEK #: 4	COVERED DATE: June 8 - 13, 2026

FOCUS: Integrate the SealGuard user interface with the Django application.

- Built improved login, dashboard, and public verification screens from the earlier static interface.
- Converted the visual design into reusable Django templates for upload, contract list, verification, and physical verification.
- Expanded PDF encryption and verification utilities and documented setup, administrator access, and the known LSB concern.

TECHNICAL OUTCOME: The security functions became accessible through a consistent branded web workflow.

ISSUE AND RESPONSE: Static mockups and backend pages differed; shared templates aligned behavior and presentation.

MANUSCRIPT ALIGNMENT: Web administrative system, public verification interface, and Agile prototype refinement.

NEXT STEP: Clean the repository and make setup reproducible.

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WEEK #: 5	COVERED DATE: June 14 - 20, 2026

FOCUS: Reorganize the repository and document a reproducible development environment.

- Revised the README to explain SealGuard features, installation, key generation, media folders, migrations, and local use.
- Added the Python dependency list required to reproduce the Django, PDF, image, QR, and cryptographic environment.
- Removed obsolete duplicate project directories and restored one canonical application tree.

TECHNICAL OUTCOME: New developers could identify the required packages and the intended project entry point.

ISSUE AND RESPONSE: Earlier uploads duplicated application folders; repository cleanup reduced maintenance risk.

MANUSCRIPT ALIGNMENT: Development and coding practices, GitHub version control, and modular Django implementation.

NEXT STEP: Address privacy, encryption, and document metadata defects.

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WEEK #: 6	COVERED DATE: June 22 - 28, 2026

FOCUS: Correct security and document-record defects discovered during integration.

- Removed exposed private information from the repository and its history, then tightened sensitive-file handling.
- Corrected encryption behavior and prevented duplicate document records from appearing unexpectedly.
- Added contract creation date, modification date, recipient, visibility, status, and related metadata fields.

TECHNICAL OUTCOME: Contract records became safer to handle and more useful for administrative tracking.

ISSUE AND RESPONSE: Security leakage and duplicate records were treated as release-blocking defects and corrected.

MANUSCRIPT ALIGNMENT: Confidentiality, data integrity, structured presentation, and secure document management.

NEXT STEP: Improve list usability and add an accountable audit trail.

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WEEK #: 7	COVERED DATE: July 6 - 12, 2026

FOCUS: Improve contract retrieval and establish activity monitoring.

- Redesigned the contracts list for clearer document status, metadata, actions, and day-to-day navigation.
- Added the AuditLog model and dashboard activity records for document and user operations.
- Connected interface actions to chronological records that support later filtering and reporting.

TECHNICAL OUTCOME: Administrators gained a clearer working list and traceable records of system activity.
ISSUE AND RESPONSE: Document actions were difficult to review after the fact; persistent activity logs added accountability.
MANUSCRIPT ALIGNMENT: Report Dashboard, audit trail, accountability, search, and document retrieval.
NEXT STEP: Refine navigation and visual consistency.

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WEEK #: 8	COVERED DATE: July 27 - August 2, 2026

FOCUS: Refine navigation, visual hierarchy, and theme consistency.

- Reworked the top navigation so key document, dashboard, and verification destinations were easier to locate.
- Improved page layouts, spacing, controls, and visual feedback across the administrative interface.
- Added more consistent theme behavior so core screens presented the same SealGuard identity.

TECHNICAL OUTCOME: The prototype became easier to navigate and more suitable for demonstration and evaluation.

ISSUE AND RESPONSE: Screen-level styles had diverged; shared navigation and theme rules reduced inconsistency.

MANUSCRIPT ALIGNMENT: Design phase mockups, administrative interface, usability, and compatibility objectives.

NEXT STEP: Improve verification feedback during longer operations.

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WEEK #: 9	COVERED DATE: August 17 - 23, 2026

FOCUS: Make the verification process understandable while the system is working.

- Added a loading workspace that displays progress while a submitted PDF is inspected.
- Organized verification feedback into visible stages instead of leaving the user with an unresponsive screen.
- Prepared the result area for clearer authentic, tampered, and error outcomes.

TECHNICAL OUTCOME: Public verification gained better status feedback and a clearer transition to results.
ISSUE AND RESPONSE: PDF analysis could appear stalled; staged loading feedback communicated ongoing work.
MANUSCRIPT ALIGNMENT: Result Display Interface, public authenticity validation, and usability evaluation.
NEXT STEP: Add document organization, version history, previews, and recovery actions.

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WEEK #: 10	COVERED DATE: August 24 - 30, 2026

FOCUS: Expand document lifecycle management and prepare repeatable test data.

- Added user folders, folder ordering, contract assignment, version history, version-source tracking, and stable base filenames.
- Improved PDF previews and encryption-footer layout, then added Trash, restore, permanent deletion, and quality-of-life controls.
- Created authentic, tampered, malformed, and edge-case PDF fixtures plus automated checks and database repair migrations.

TECHNICAL OUTCOME: SealGuard could organize, revise, preview, recover, and test contracts through a fuller lifecycle.

ISSUE AND RESPONSE: Revisions and deletions lacked traceability; version chains and recoverable Trash reduced that risk.

MANUSCRIPT ALIGNMENT: Document Management, version control, tamper detection, and alpha unit/integration testing.

NEXT STEP: Strengthen mobile use, logs, tutorials, and regression coverage.

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WEEK #: 11	COVERED DATE: August 31 - September 1, 2026

FOCUS: Improve responsive use, verification evidence, tutorials, and automated regression checks.

- Added responsive navigation and mobile-safe preview behavior across the main templates.
- Expanded secret-safe verification and encryption process logs and retained supporting evidence for tampered results.
- Added administrator-managed Help and Tutorials with sanitized content, starter topics, and permission-checked editing.

TECHNICAL OUTCOME: Users received clearer guidance and verification evidence on desktop and smaller screens.

ISSUE AND RESPONSE: Results and help were fragmented; the loading workspace, detailed log, and tutorial module unified guidance.

MANUSCRIPT ALIGNMENT: Compatibility testing, user training, public verification, and deployment documentation.

NEXT STEP: Harden navigation, pagination, physical checks, and access control.

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WEEK #: 12	COVERED DATE: September 2 - 3, 2026

FOCUS: Harden mobile operation, signed-document verification, authentication, and role permissions.

- Replaced the mobile sidebar with top navigation and added scrolling, pagination, inline tutorial icons, and versioned filenames.
- Retained tampered-PDF evidence and added signed physical-document manifests, per-page tokens, page-order checks, and manual review.
- Logged authentication events, enforced five-attempt temporary lockout, and clarified Superuser, Clerk, and Public permissions.

TECHNICAL OUTCOME: The system better protected privileged actions and verified both digital and signed physical workflows.

ISSUE AND RESPONSE: Mobile access and role boundaries were inconsistent; responsive and server-side controls closed the gaps.

MANUSCRIPT ALIGNMENT: RBAC, brute-force testing, mobile verification, scanning, tamper detection, and audit monitoring.

NEXT STEP: Stabilize the suite and complete document-management reporting.

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WEEK #: 13	COVERED DATE: September 4 - 5, 2026

FOCUS: Stabilize automated tests and complete document-selection and bulk lifecycle actions.

- Fixed regressions and expanded authentication, authorization, cryptographic, physical-verification, and document tests.
- Added duplicate-aware upload selection, audited view/download behavior, checkbox selection, select-all, and permission-checked bulk Trash actions.
- Added bulk permanent deletion, report filters, pagination persistence, CSV export checks, and document-management test reporting.

TECHNICAL OUTCOME: The committed report records 12 of 12 document-management methods and 73 of 73 contracts tests passing.

ISSUE AND RESPONSE: Selection and reporting paths were under-tested; explicit DOC-01 to DOC-12 matrices made results repeatable.

MANUSCRIPT ALIGNMENT: Alpha unit, integration, reliability, cybersecurity, compatibility, and deployment-readiness testing.

NEXT STEP: Proceed to manual browser/mobile checks and formal user acceptance testing.

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